

TWELVE HOOKS

Contribution to the single targeted v2.2 replacement field · Claude's twelve of twenty-four · 2026-08-25

Status: HOOKS, not premises. Not engineered. No access map, no agency design, no production data. Nothing here has been through Kill Gate Zero and nothing should be until it survives a reader.

Generated using `true-crime-genre-anatomy` for the first time, under the lifted ban. Every hook names two structural influences. No influence pair repeats.

Rules applied: murder or disappearance stated immediately · reason to care contains no trade term and no proper noun · arguable central question before any evidence · stake limited to body, freedom, family, identity or present danger · a living person visible as danger, beneficiary, suspect or protector before the evidence appears · no reversal resting primarily on one small quantitative correction.

Deliberate corrections to the rejected field: eleven of twelve place an intimate or family relationship at the centre, which none of the previous twenty-one did. Districts are spread across all six rather than concentrated in the harbour, since the harbour supplied most of the vocabulary that lost Trish.

FAMILY ONE: FRESH

F1

A woman is beaten to death in her own kitchen in Highcliff Heights. Her husband's grief is completely convincing and half the district has organised around him. Her sister is the only person saying the marriage was not what it looked like, and she is now the most hated woman in Havenbay. The husband has agreed to talk to Ally, at length, on the record, because he believes he will be good at it.

Influences: community secret (primary) + accused participation **Stake:** family · **Living tension:** the husband, giving interviews, raising their daughter **District:** Highcliff Heights

F2

A seventeen-year-old boy is stabbed at the Civic Row interchange in front of forty people. Everyone filmed it. Nobody helped. Another boy is charged, and he was there, but so were eleven others, and one of them has started telling his girlfriend a version that does not match his statement. The phones that recorded it are still in the pockets of children who are frightened of each other.

Influences: investigative breakthrough, collective reconstruction (primary) + disputed day **Stake:** freedom · **Living tension:** the boy who is talking, and the group that knows he is **District:** Downtown Civic Row

F3

A man is found dead at the bottom of the Highcliff steps and it is recorded as a fall. His daughter says he had been frightened of someone for months and would not say who. She has now worked out who, because the officer who took her father's report and recorded no further action is the same man her father crossed at work.

Influences: visible conflict of interest (primary) + repeated institutional act **Stake:** body · **Living tension:** an officer with a reason to prefer a fall **District:** Highcliff Heights

F4

A woman is murdered in the Arts Quarter and her best friend starts receiving her things in the post. A hair clip. A library card. A shoe. One item a week, no note, always things that were on the body or in the flat. The police say a person close to the investigation is doing it. The friend has stopped sleeping and has started answering.

Influences: active predator (primary) + accused participation **Stake:** present danger · **Living tension:** whoever is posting, still choosing what to send next **District:** Havenbay University and Arts Quarter

FAMILY TWO: NEVER SOLVED OR MISCLASSIFIED

N1

Twenty-two years ago a woman walked out of a Rivermouth house and never came back, and everyone agreed she had run off with a man from the next street. That man did not disappear. He has lived four suburbs away the entire time, married, on the electoral roll, and in twenty-two years nobody official ever knocked on his door, because the story was too tidy to check. Her daughter is now older than her mother ever got to be.

Influences: proximity, the suspect never left (primary) + community secret **Stake:** body · **Living tension:** a man who has been findable for twenty-two years **District:** Rivermouth Industrial

N2

A woman reported the same man to police four times in two years. On the fifth occasion she was dead, and it was recorded as a domestic incident with no further action because the man had an explanation each time and she had withdrawn twice. All four reports exist. Two were taken by the same officer. He is still in the job, and the man is living with somebody new.

Influences: repeated institutional act (primary) + active predator **Stake:** present danger · **Living tension:** the man, and the woman currently in the house with him **District:** Old Docks and Harbor Ward

N3

A man is pulled out of the water below Pier 13 and it is called a suicide within a day. He had bought two concert tickets for the following week and had just paid a deposit on a holiday with his daughter. His wife accepted the finding immediately, insisted on a fast funeral, and has spent nine years refusing to let anyone reopen it. His daughter has never once been allowed to ask why.

Influences: community secret, the family enforced the account (primary) + disputed day **Stake:** family · **Living tension:** a widow protecting something, in the same house as the daughter **District:** Old Docks and Harbor Ward

N4

A young woman died at a house in the Arts Quarter eleven years ago and the man who was with her that night has never been charged. He has told the story so many times it has become a performance, and he now wants to tell it to Ally, on her show, in his own words. He is not frightened of her. He thinks she is an opportunity. Ally has to decide whether to hand him a microphone.

Influences: accused participation (primary) + proximity, the suspect never left **Stake:** identity, whose account of her death survives · **Living tension:** a man who wants the platform **District:** Havenbay University and Arts Quarter

FAMILY THREE: OFFICIALLY SOLVED BUT CONTESTED

S1

A woman has served eleven years for a murder she says she did not commit. The case rested on one witness. That witness is her brother-in-law, and he has raised her son since the boy was eight. The boy is nineteen now and has not visited her in four years. Nobody at the trial asked what the witness stood to gain, because the answer was sitting in the public gallery holding his hand.

Rebuilt from the salvaged human engine of the retired C11. The visibility calculation is not carried forward.

Influences: disputed day, one unreliable narrator (primary) + visible conflict of interest **Stake:** freedom · **Living tension:** the witness, who now has the most to lose **District:** Stonebridge Viaduct

S2

A man confessed at nineteen and has served twenty-six years. He has never once described the killing in his own words. Every detail in his statement had already been printed in the Gazette that week. His mother has always said he was protecting somebody, and his younger brother, who was fifteen at the time, has never visited him, not once, in twenty-six years.

Influences: disputed day (primary) + community secret **Stake:** family · **Living tension:** the brother who has never come **District:** Downtown Civic Row

S3

A man is serving life for a killing at a crowded street festival, convicted because two witnesses picked him out. Two hundred people were photographing that street. Nobody ever collected those photographs. When Ally asks her listeners to send them in, the same unidentified man appears in eleven of them, standing close behind the victim in the minutes beforehand, and no one has ever asked who he was.

Influences: missing identity (primary) + investigative breakthrough, collective reconstruction **Stake:** identity, of a man nobody looked for · **Living tension:** a face in eleven photographs who has never been named **District:** Downtown Civic Row

S4

A man was tried for his partner's murder and acquitted. He has remarried. Her mother has spent nine years telling anybody who will listen that the new wife is in danger, and everybody has decided she is a grieving woman who cannot let go. She has been to the police eleven times. The new wife has recently stopped answering her own phone.

Influences: active predator (primary) + community secret **Stake:** present danger · **Living tension:** the new wife, and a mother nobody believes **District:** Highcliff Heights

DISTRIBUTION CHECK

Primary engine, my twelve. Community secret 2 · accused participation 1 · investigative breakthrough 1 · visible conflict of interest 1 · active predator 2 · proximity 2 · repeated institutional act 1 · disputed day 2 · missing identity 1. **Maximum two.** Leaves at least three slots per engine for the other twelve under the field-wide cap of five.

Stake, per family. Fresh: family, freedom, body, present danger. Never solved: body, present danger, family, identity. Contested: freedom, family, identity, present danger. **Four distinct in every family.**

Influence pairs. Twelve distinct pairs, none repeated.

Intimate or family relationship at the centre: eleven of twelve. The exception is F2, which is adolescent peer pressure, and is deliberate.

Occupational or administrative stake: zero.

WHAT I AM NOT CLAIMING

These have not been through Kill Gate Zero and several will not survive it. **F3 and N2 are the exposed ones**, because both put a police officer's conduct at the centre and Gate Zero forbids invented powers and incompetent professionals. Both are written as discretion misused rather than authority invented, which is permitted, and both still need the audit.

Three carry a real research dependency that must be answered before engineering, not assumed: what a coronial finding of suicide requires before it can be recorded that fast (N3), what happens to repeat reports about the same person and who can later obtain them (N2), and whether a conviction can be reviewed on newly surfaced photographic material and who decides (S3).

Per the standing practice ruled 2026-08-25: where a premise depends on a Havenbay process that is not yet settled, ask for the ruling. Do not kill the seed and do not invent the answer.